

MediaInfo (MediaArea) — Licensing & Technical Due-Diligence for PreflightQC

DEPENDENCY

MediaInfo / MediaInfoLib by MediaArea.net SARL — proposed as a local video-file inspection dependency inside “PreflightQC”, a closed-source, commercial, downloadable desktop application. Components under review: MediaInfo CLI (`mediainfo / mediainfo.exe`), MediaInfoLib (the library: `MediaInfo.dll / libmediainfo.so / libmediainfo.dylib`), and the MediaInfo GUI. Base-class dependency ZenLib (`libzen`) is also in scope.

VERSION/RELEASE CHECKED

- **MediaInfo 26.05**, released **12 May 2026** — current stable as of August 2026. Confirmed on GitHub Releases (MediaArea/MediaInfo): “g-maxime released this · 12 May 09:35 ... v26.05 ... signed with GitHub’s verified signature. GPG key ID: B5690EEEBB952194 · Verified”, and on the official ChangeLog: “Version 26.05, 2026-05-12”. The MediaInfoLib repository likewise shows “26.05 Latest May 12, 2026”.
- Prior stable references: 26.01 (early 2026); 25.10 (6 November 2025).
- Licence text checked against the master-branch `LICENSE` (dated “2002-2025”), `License.html` (master), and the official licence page mediaarea.net/en/MediaInfo/License (dated “2002-2026”).
- ZenLib checked against MediaArea/ZenLib master.

LICENCE

Current licence: BSD 2-Clause License (“Simplified/FreeBSD License”). Authoritative and consistent across all three primary sources:

- github.com/MediaArea/MediaInfo/blob/master/LICENSE : “BSD 2-Clause License / Copyright (c) 2002-2025, MediaArea.net SARL / All rights reserved.”
- github.com/MediaArea/MediaInfoLib README: “This program is freeware under BSD-2-Clause license conditions. See License.html for more information.” 
- mediaarea.net/en/MediaInfo/License : “Copyright (c) 2002-2026 MediaArea.net SARL. All rights reserved. Redistribution and use in source and binary forms, with or without modification, are permitted provided that the following conditions are met...”

Historical licence change (material to the version you pin): Wikipedia (non-authoritative, but consistent with MediaArea’s own history) states verbatim: “Up to version 0.7.62 the MediaInfo library was licensed under the GNU Lesser General Public License, while GUI and CLI were provided under the terms of the GNU General Public License. Starting with version 0.7.63 the project switched to a BSD 2-clause license.”  **Any version 0.7.63 or later (which includes 26.05) is BSD-2-Clause. Versions ≤ 0.7.62 carry GPL/LGPL copyleft obligations and must not be used.**

Additional relicensing option (authoritative, in License.html master): MediaInfo’s own `License.html`

contains an "Alternate open source licenses" clause: "You can relicense (including source headers change) MedialInfo under Apache License 2.0 or later, and/or GNU Lesser General Public License 2.1 or later, and/or GNU General Public License 2.0 or later, and/or Mozilla Public License 2.0 or later." This grant widens (never narrows) your options; you may simply rely on the default BSD-2-Clause terms.

Component-by-component (checked separately, not assumed identical):

- **MedialInfoLib (library/DLL/.so/.dylib):** BSD-2-Clause. Source headers state "Use of this source code is governed by a BSD-style license that can be found in the License.html file." [GitHub](#)
- **MedialInfo CLI:** BSD-2-Clause. The MediaArea FAQ (mediaarea.net/en/MedialInfo/Support/FAQ) states verbatim: "MedialInfoCmd is governed by a BSD-style license."
- **MedialInfo GUI:** MedialInfo's own GUI code is BSD-2-Clause — the same FAQ states "MedialInfoGUI is governed by a BSD-style license." **However**, the GUI links a GUI toolkit — **Qt** or **wxWidgets** (both listed as optional GUI dependencies in License.html) — which introduces additional third-party licence obligations distinct from MedialInfo's own BSD terms (see PROHIBITED/UNSAFE CONFIGURATIONS). **PreflightQC does not need the GUI.**
- **ZenLib (libzen): zlib licence** (authoritative: ZenLib README "This program is freeware under zlib license conditions"; source headers say "governed by a zlib-style license... License.txt"). The zlib licence is permissive and, unlike BSD, has no binary-form licence-reproduction clause, though its no-misrepresentation-of-origin and altered-version-marking terms apply.

COMMERCIAL USE

Permitted. The BSD-2-Clause text imposes no field-of-use or commercial restriction: "Redistribution and use in source and binary forms, with or without modification, are permitted provided that the following conditions are met" (mediaarea.net/en/MedialInfo/License; identical in the repository LICENSE). There is no clause restricting commercial or closed-source use, and no copyleft reciprocal-source obligation. **Interpretation (flag for legal sign-off):** BSD-2-Clause is universally treated as compatible with closed-source commercial redistribution; the licence text supports this, but the conclusion that it is "commercially safe" is interpretation and requires final human/legal confirmation — do not treat the permissive wording alone as clearance.

REDISTRIBUTION

Permitted, including alongside a proprietary application, subject to the binary-form condition. The operative clause (verbatim, mediaarea.net/en/MedialInfo/License):

"Redistributions in binary form must reproduce the above copyright notice, this list of conditions and the following disclaimer in the documentation and/or other materials provided with the distribution."

MediaArea additionally provides an **"Alternate license for redistributions of the library in binary form"** (verbatim):

"Redistributions in binary form must reproduce the following sentence (including the link to the website) in the documentation and/or other materials provided with the distribution. This product uses MedialInfo library, Copyright (c) 2002-2026 MediaArea.net SARL."

So for a binary-only bundle you may satisfy the obligation either by reproducing the full BSD notice + list of conditions + disclaimer, or by using the short "This product uses MedialInfo library, Copyright (c) 2002-2026 MediaArea.net SARL" attribution sentence (including the website link). Either form must appear in the

documentation/about materials shipped with PreflightQC.

SOURCE DISCLOSURE

Not required for any of the three components at their current licences. BSD-2-Clause (library, CLI, MedialInfo's own GUI code) and zlib (ZenLib) are both non-copyleft; you may ship binaries only, keep PreflightQC closed-source, and are under no obligation to publish or offer MedialInfo/ZenLib source.

- **Library:** no source disclosure.
- **CLI:** no source disclosure.
- **GUI:** MedialInfo's own GUI code imposes no source disclosure, **but** shipping the GUI linked against a copyleft-configured toolkit (e.g. Qt under LGPL/GPL, or wxWidgets) triggers those toolkits' own re-linking/source-availability conditions. This is the one place copyleft could re-enter. PreflightQC should not ship the GUI, eliminating the issue.
- **Copyleft implication:** Only relevant if you (a) pin a pre-0.7.63 GPL/LGPL version, or (b) bundle the GUI with a copyleft toolkit build. Neither is required.

ATTRIBUTION

- **Required:** Reproduce the MediaArea copyright notice (and, in the full-text form, the list of conditions and the disclaimer) in binary distributions — see REQUIRED NOTICE FILES.
- **No endorsement / names clause:** BSD-2-Clause is the *2-clause* variant, which — unlike BSD-3-Clause — **omits** the "no-endorsement / use-of-names" clause. There is therefore no explicit non-endorsement obligation in the MedialInfo licence text. **Interpretation:** you still should not imply MediaArea endorses PreflightQC (general trademark/passing-off law applies independently of the licence). MediaArea's licence contains no trademark grant; "MedialInfo" and the logo are MediaArea's — use the name only descriptively.
- **ZenLib (zlib licence):** requires that you not misrepresent the origin of the software and not claim you wrote it; altered versions must be plainly marked. ZenLib attribution is satisfied by acknowledging MediaArea (already covered by MedialInfo's third-party list).

REQUIRED NOTICE FILES

To comply for a Windows/macOS binary distribution of PreflightQC, include in your shipped documentation / "Third-party notices" / About box:

1. **MedialInfo BSD-2-Clause notice** — the copyright line plus the two conditions plus the "AS IS" disclaimer, OR the short-form sentence: *"This product uses MedialInfo library, Copyright (c) 2002-2026 MediaArea.net SARL"* (with the mediaarea.net/MedialInfo link).
2. **Third-party sub-notice for anything actually linked/bundled**, per MedialInfo's own License.html list:
 - **ZenLib** — "(c) MediaArea.net SARL, zlib license."
 - **zlib** (if the gzip-decompression routine is compiled in) — zlib licence notice.
 - **libcurl** (only if a network-enabled build/sidecar is shipped) — curl copyright notice.
 - **TinyXML-2** (only if XML parsing compiled in) — TinyXML-2 notice.

- **The C++ standard library** (libstdc++ / libc++ / MSVC runtime) as applicable.
 - **libmms** and **AES routines (Brian Gladman)** only if those optional features are compiled in.
3. Recommended: reproduce the exact copyright holder string **"MediaArea.net SARL"** verbatim, and keep the year range as published in the version you ship (repository LICENSE says "2002-2025"; the website says "2002-2026" — use the string that matches your pinned build's LICENSE file).

BUNDLING RECOMMENDATION

Recommended: link/ship the MediaInfoLib library (dynamic `MediaInfo.dll` / `libmediainfo.dylib`) and call it via its C API/wrapper — NOT the GUI, and generally in preference to shelling out to the CLI. Rationale:

- **Licensing:** CLI and library are both BSD-2-Clause, so licensing does **not** favour one over the other (unlike GPL-era tools where CLI-as-subprocess is used to avoid *linking* copyleft — that reasoning does **not** apply here). Either is safe.
- **Dynamic vs static linking:** Under BSD-2-Clause, **linking mode is legally irrelevant** — there is no copyleft, so static and dynamic linking carry the same minimal obligation: reproduce the notice in binary distributions. Choose on engineering grounds. (Contrast: had you been on the pre-0.7.63 LGPL library, dynamic linking plus relink capability would have mattered greatly. It does not at 26.05.)
- **Practical trade-offs:**
 - *Library (recommended):* structured, in-process retrieval via the stable `MediaInfo_*` C API (Open/Get/Inform/Option), no per-file process-spawn overhead, no output-parsing fragility, direct access to named parameters, and easy JSON/XML output via `Option("Output", "JSON")` . Downside: you manage the native handle and marshalling.
 - *CLI-as-subprocess:* simplest integration, strong process isolation (a crash/hang on a malformed file does not take down PreflightQC), trivial to pin a signed executable. Downsides: per-file process spawn cost, you must parse stdout (use `--Output=JSON` for stability), and you still ship/attribute the same binary.
- **Robustness tip:** For a QC tool ingesting untrusted customer files, subprocess isolation is a genuine security/stability advantage; a hybrid (library by default, CLI sandbox for suspect files) is defensible. Either way, **do not ship the GUI**.

METADATA CAPABILITIES

MediaInfo exposes all fields PreflightQC requires. Parameter names below are the machine names usable with `-Inform="<Stream>,%Param%"` or the library `Get()` call. Reliability caveats reflect that MediaInfo reports what is present in the container/bitstream and may need a full parse (`Option("ParseSpeed", "1.0")`) for some values.

Field	Exposed?	MediaInfo parameter name(s)	Reliability / caveats & limitations
container	Yes	General <code>Format</code> , <code>Format/String</code> , <code>Format_Profile</code> , <code>CodecID</code>	Reliable; container-level. <code>Format_Commercial</code> gives vendor name.
codec	Yes	Video/Audio <code>Format</code> , <code>CodecID</code> , <code>Format/Info</code>	Reliable. Prefer <code>Format</code> (e.g. "HEVC") over legacy <code>Codec</code> .
			Reliable when present in bitstream;

profile	Yes	Format_Profile (e.g. "Main 10@ L5.1@High ")	may combine profile@level@tier in one string — must be parsed.
level	Yes	Format_Profile (embedded, e.g. "@L5.1"); sometimes Format_Level	Level is frequently reported inside Format_Profile, not a standalone field for all codecs — container/codec-dependent.
resolution	Yes	Video Width, Height (pixels); Sampled_Width/Height, Stored_Width/Height	Reliable. Width / Height are coded pixels; use stored vs clean-aperture variants where cropping applies.
display aspect ratio	Yes	DisplayAspectRatio, DisplayAspectRatio/String, DisplayAspectRatio_Original, DisplayAspectRatio_CleanAperture	Reliable; may be derived. Original vs clean-aperture variants exist.
pixel aspect ratio	Yes	PixelAspectRatio, PixelAspectRatio_Original	Reliable; may be inferred from DAR/storage dimensions when not explicitly coded.
frame rate	Yes	FrameRate, FrameRate/String, FrameRate_Num, FrameRate_Den, FrameRate_Original	Reliable; for VFR the reported value can be nominal/average — check mode. Numerator/denominator available for exact rational (e.g. 24000/1001).
frame-rate mode	Yes	FrameRate_Mode (CFR/VFR), FrameRate_Mode_Original	Container-dependent; some containers do not signal it — may be absent or inferred.
bitrate	Yes	Video/Audio BitRate, BitRate_Mode, BitRate_Nominal, BitRate_Maximum; General OverallBitRate	Reliable when signalled; otherwise estimated from size/duration ("risky bitrate estimation") — may require full parse.
duration	Yes	Duration (ms), Duration/String	Reliable; container vs stream duration can differ slightly.
file size	Yes	General FileSize, FileSize/String	Reliable (filesystem value).
audio codec	Yes	Audio Format, CodecID, Format_Commercial	Reliable. Per-track.
sample rate	Yes	Audio SamplingRate, SamplingRate/String	Reliable.
channels	Yes	Audio Channel(s), ChannelPositions, ChannelLayout	Reliable; positions/layout give L/R/C/LFE mapping.
bit depth	Yes	BitDepth (video and audio); BitDepth_Detected, BitDepth_Stored	Reliable when coded. Some codecs (e.g. ProRes) may not carry explicit video bit depth — may be

			inferred/absent.
colour primaries	Yes	Video colour_primaries , colour_primaries_Original	Reliable when colour description present; absent if the stream carries no colour description. Note British spelling colour_.
transfer characteristics	Yes	Video transfer_characteristics , transfer_characteristics_Original	Reliable when present; key HDR discriminator (values "PQ", "HLG"). May be absent in files lacking colour description.
matrix coefficients	Yes	Video matrix_coefficients , matrix_coefficients_Original	Reliable when present; unique per ISO integer value.
HDR metadata (HDR10, HDR10+, Dolby Vision, HLG, MaxCLL/MaxFALL, mastering display)	Yes	HDR_Format , HDR_Format/String , HDR_Format_Commercial , HDR_Format_Version , HDR_Format_Profile , HDR_Format_Level , HDR_Format_Settings , HDR_Format_Compatibility ; MasteringDisplay_ColorPrimaries , MasteringDisplay_Luminance ; MaxCLL , MaxFALL	Powerful but caveated: HDR10 shows as "SMPTE ST 2086, HDR10 compatible"; Dolby Vision shows profile/level (e.g. "dvhe.08.06, BL+RPU") plus fallback compatibility; HDR10+ appears as "SMPTE ST 2094 App 4". Limitations: Dolby Vision in raw HEVC (NALU type 62) historically not reported (MediaInfoLib issue #1482); HLG can be mis-labelled where ST 2086 is present (MediaInfo issue #833); MaxCLL/MaxFALL only present if the encoder actually wrote them (may be absent even in valid HDR). Use HDR_Format_Compatibility for HDR10 fallback detection; HLG is detectable via transfer_characteristics =HLG even when HDR_Format is sparse.
scan type (progressive/interlaced) + scan order / field order	Yes	Video ScanType , ScanType/String ; ScanOrder , ScanOrder/String (e.g. "Top Field First", "2:3 Pulldown")	Reliable when signalled, but MediaInfo reads container/stream flags, not pixels — it "doesn't have eyes", VideoHelp so mislabelled/soft-telecined files can report misleading scan type/order, and some files report no scan type at all. Treat as advisory; confirm visually for edge cases.

RISKS

- **Licence-change risk (low, but pin your version):** MediaInfo has already made one major licence change (LGPL/GPL → BSD-2-Clause at 0.7.63), and MediaArea reserves broad relicensing options in License.html. *Mitigation:* pin an exact BSD-2-Clause version (26.05), archive that version's LICENSE/License.html with

your build, and re-review on upgrade. BSD-2-Clause grants for a version already received are effectively irrevocable, so an upstream change cannot retroactively affect a shipped pinned build.

- **Supply-chain risk (medium — action required):** Download binaries only from mediaarea.net or the official MediaArea GitHub releases. Third-party “mediainfo.dll” download sites (dll-files.com, dllme.com, iosninja.io, etc.) are **not authoritative and must not be used**. Historically the MedialInfo installer bundled the “OpenCandy” adware component; per Wikipedia (non-authoritative but corroborated): “MedialInfo installer was previously bundled with ‘OpenCandy’. However, you were able continue the installation process without installing it. This is no more the case since April 2016.” Verify official downloads by published SHA-256 checksum. **Authenticode code-signing status of the official Windows MediaInfo.dll could not be confirmed from any authoritative MediaArea source and must be verified directly on the binary (`signtool verify`) before shipping.**
- **Bundled-dependency risk (low, but must be inventoried):** Official binaries statically link ZenLib (zlib licence) and, per build, zlib (zlib licence) and the C++ runtime; a network-enabled build additionally ships **libcurl** (and, in third-party repackages such as the NuGet MedialInfo.Native, **OpenSSL**, **libssh2**, **Brotli** as sidecar DLLs).  Each carries its own permissive licence and attribution obligation. *Mitigation:* prefer a minimal/default configuration **without** libcurl/network support (PreflightQC inspects local files only), removing libcurl/OpenSSL/libssh2 and their notices from your obligation set entirely.
- **Prebuilt vs self-built difference:** The official prebuilt default `MediaInfo.dll` links third-party libs **statically into one DLL** (curl uses `CURL_STATICLIB`; zlib is static by default per MedialInfoLib issue #1437); network support is **not** in the base DLL and is enabled via a **sidecar** `libcurl.dll` or a dedicated “with libcurl” build. A minimal self-build lets you exclude libcurl, libmms, TinyXML-2 and AES, shrinking your notice list. Confirm the exact feature set of whatever binary you actually ship.
- **Ambiguities for legal review:** (1) confirm which short-form vs full-form BSD notice you will use and where it appears; (2) confirm the third-party notice list matches the *actual* compiled feature set of the shipped binary; (3) confirm the Authenticode signature of the official DLL or sign your own bundle; (4) confirm no trademark issue in how “MedialInfo” is referenced in PreflightQC’s UI/marketing.

PROHIBITED/UNSAFE CONFIGURATIONS

- **Do NOT ship any MedialInfo version $\leq 0.7.62$** — those are GPL (CLI/GUI) / LGPL (library) and would impose copyleft/source-availability obligations incompatible with closed-source PreflightQC.
- **Do NOT bundle the MedialInfo GUI** — it links Qt or wxWidgets, adding toolkit licence obligations (and potential LGPL/GPL re-linking/source conditions depending on the toolkit build). PreflightQC does not need it.
- **Do NOT ship a build that statically links a copyleft-configured dependency** (e.g. a GPL-configured Qt in the GUI, or any GPL codec/parser added downstream). Use the library/CLI, which are BSD-2-Clause.
- **Do NOT omit the required binary-form notice** — shipping `MediaInfo.dll` /CLI without reproducing the MediaArea copyright notice/disclaimer (or the short-form sentence) in your documentation/about materials breaches the one active BSD-2-Clause condition.
- **Do NOT source binaries from unofficial DLL-download sites.**
- **Do NOT enable/ship the libcurl network feature unless needed** — it enlarges your third-party notice obligations (curl, and typically OpenSSL/libssh2/Brotli) for no benefit to a local-only QC tool.

Windows DISTRIBUTION IMPLICATIONS

- Use the official `MediaInfo_DLL_<version>_Windows_x64_WithoutInstaller.zip` (and `_i386` for 32-bit) from [mediaarea.net](https://mediaarea.net/en/MediaInfo/Download/Windows) / official GitHub. The default package centres on a single `MediaInfo.dll` with statically linked ZenLib/zlib/C++ runtime, plus a `Developers` examples folder and the licence/history files.
- **Runtime dependencies:** MediaArea's build is statically linked to the multithreaded C++ runtime. The FAQ states verbatim: "the project is statically linked to the multithreaded C++ library, and options are C++ compliant." Consequently the core `MediaInfo.dll` generally does **not** require a separately installed Microsoft Visual C++ Redistributable. Verify against your pinned build.
- **Network components:** The default DLL does **not** include libcurl; HTTP(S)/FTP(S) support requires a **sidecar** `libcurl.dll` (MediaArea) (MediaArea FAQ). Omit it — PreflightQC reads local files.
- **Code signing:** Whether the official `MediaInfo.dll` is Authenticode-signed by MediaArea could not be authoritatively confirmed; **treat as unsigned and Authenticode-sign your full PreflightQC bundle yourself** (SmartScreen and enterprise deployment expect a signature on your shipped binaries regardless).

macOS IMPLICATIONS (if PreflightQC ships on macOS)

- Official macOS builds are provided by MediaArea (mediaarea.net/en/MediaInfo/Download/Mac_OS), including CLI and `libmediainfo.dylib`; MediaInfo is also on the Mac App Store (v26.05). Licensing is identical (BSD-2-Clause + ZenLib zlib).
- **Universal binary:** MediaArea ships universal (Intel x86_64 + Apple Silicon arm64) builds, but there is a **known, serious defect**: per MediaInfoLib issue #2263, the official macOS dylib's x86_64 slice became effectively broken — the reporter's `otool -vf libmediainfo.0.dylib` shows the x86_64 slice at only "size 22832" bytes versus arm64 "size 8477280", and tinyMediaManager fails on x86_64 with "Error looking up function 'MediaInfo_Option': dlsym(...): symbol not found" while arm64 works. Issue #1961 corroborates: "Since version 23.11 ... the official download of the MediaInfo DyLib for macOS no longer exports any symbols for the x86_64 architecture." **Do not assume the official prebuilt dylib is a working universal binary — test both architectures on your pinned version, and self-build the x86_64 slice if broken.**
- **Signing/notarization:** You must **code-sign the bundled `libmediainfo.dylib` with your own Apple Developer ID and notarize** the PreflightQC app; do not rely on MediaArea's signing. (Third-party precompiled MediaInfo-based tools are frequently "not notarized or signed", forcing quarantine-flag stripping — an experience you cannot ship to customers.) Hardened Runtime plus a Developer ID signature on every embedded dylib is required for notarization.

SOURCE REGISTER

Authoritative (MediaArea official / primary licence text):

- <https://mediaarea.net/en/MediaInfo/License> — current official licence page; BSD-2-Clause text, binary alternate notice, third-party library list, copyright "2002-2026 MediaArea.net SARL". *Authoritative.*
- <https://github.com/MediaArea/MediaInfo/blob/master/LICENSE> — repository BSD 2-Clause text, "Copyright (c) 2002-2025, MediaArea.net SARL". *Authoritative.*
- <https://github.com/MediaArea/MediaInfo/blob/master/License.html> — full licence incl. "Alternate open source licenses" relicensing clause and third-party (Qt/wxWidgets/TinyXML-2/zlib/libcurl/AES/libmms) list.

Authoritative.

- <https://github.com/MediaArea/MediaInfoLib> — README/licence (“freeware under BSD-2-Clause”), release list (26.05, 12 May 2026). *Authoritative.*
- <https://github.com/MediaArea/MediaInfoLib/blob/master/Source/MediaInfoDLL/MediaInfoDLL.h> (and [.cs/.vb/.py](#)) — source headers confirming BSD-style licence on the DLL interface. *Authoritative.*
- <https://github.com/MediaArea/ZenLib> + source headers (Conf.h, File.h, Ztring.h) — ZenLib under zlib licence. *Authoritative.*
- <https://mediaarea.net/en/MediaInfo/Download>, .../Download/Windows, .../Download/Mac_OS — official distribution channels. *Authoritative.*
- <https://mediaarea.net/MediaInfo/ChangeLog> — “Version 26.05, 2026-05-12”. *Authoritative.*
- <https://github.com/MediaArea/MediaInfo/releases> — v26.05 release, GPG-verified, 12 May 2026. *Authoritative.*
- <https://mediaarea.net/en/MediaInfo> — feature/field list (container/video/audio/scan type/scan order). *Authoritative.*
- <https://mediaarea.net/en/MediaInfo/Support/FAQ> — CLI/GUI “governed by a BSD-style license”; static multithreaded C++ runtime linking; sidecar libcurl.dll requirement. *Authoritative.*
- <https://mediaarea.net/en/MediaInfo/Support/Fields> — official field/parameter reference. *Authoritative.*
- <https://github.com/MediaArea/MediaInfoLib/issues/2263> and .../issues/1961 — macOS universal dylib x86_64 defect. *Authoritative (project issue tracker).*
- <https://github.com/MediaArea/MediaInfoLib/issues/1437> — zlib static-vs-DLL build behaviour. *Authoritative.*
- <https://github.com/MediaArea/MediaInfoLib/pull/1088>, .../issues/1482, <https://github.com/MediaArea/MediaInfo/issues/833> — HDR/HDR10+/Dolby Vision field behaviour and known limitations. *Authoritative.*

Non-authoritative (context/corroboration only; not used for licensing conclusions):

- <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/MediaInfo> — licence history (0.7.62→0.7.63), OpenCandy history. *Non-authoritative; corroborates MediaArea history.*
- <https://staxrip2.readthedocs.io/en/latest/mediainfo.html>, <https://mediainfo.js.org/api/interface/VideoTrack/> — parameter-name references. *Non-authoritative.*
- <https://www.nuget.org/packages/MediaInfo.Native> and .../MediaInfoDLL — third-party repackages listing bundled libcurl/OpenSSL/libssh2/Brotli sidecar DLLs. *Non-authoritative repackager.*
- <https://forum.videohelp.com/...>, <https://sourceforge.net/p/mediainfo/...>, <https://www.filebot.net/forums/...> — real-world field/HDR/scan-order behaviour examples. *Non-authoritative.*
- <https://community.chocolatey.org/packages/mediainfo> — official installer SHA-256 checksum/version corroboration. *Non-authoritative packager.*
- <https://ports.macports.org/port/mediainfolib/>, <https://formulae.brew.sh/formula/libzen>,

<https://packages.gentoo.org/packages/media-libs/libzen> — distro licence metadata (BSD/Zlib). *Non-authoritative*.

- Third-party DLL-download sites (dll-files.com, dllme.com, iosninja.io, etc.) — **flagged as unsafe; not used for conclusions**.

FINAL VERDICT

APPROVED WITH CONDITIONS.

MediaInfo 26.05 (MediaInfoLib + CLI) is licensed under **BSD-2-Clause**, and ZenLib under the **zlib licence** — both permissive, both allowing closed-source commercial redistribution with no source-disclosure and no copyleft, subject only to reproducing the copyright notice/disclaimer (or MediaArea's short-form attribution sentence) in binary distributions. It technically exposes every metadata field PreflightQC requires.

Approval is conditioned on: (1) pinning a **≥ 0.7.63 / current 26.05** BSD-era build and archiving its LICENSE; (2) **not shipping the GUI** and not shipping any copyleft-toolkit or pre-0.7.63 build; (3) including the **MediaArea BSD notice plus third-party notices** matching the actual compiled feature set (ZenLib always; zlib/libcurl/etc. only if present); (4) sourcing binaries **only** from official MediaArea channels and verifying checksums; (5) **code-signing your own bundle** on Windows and **signing + notarizing** embedded dylibs on macOS (and testing the macOS universal dylib's x86_64 slice, which has a documented breakage); and (6) a **final human/legal review** confirming the notice wording and the exact bundled-dependency inventory. The "commercially safe" conclusion rests on interpretation of permissive licence text and must receive that final legal sign-off before release.